

noise generator as well, just to make it sound like a “real” car (this last bit is actually useful if the car is too silent, to warn pedestrians).

There comes a point when you have started to reproduce the inefficiencies and negative attributes just for the sake of familiarity. An example of this in software would be the use of a volume knob instead of a straightforward slider. The knob looks more familiar, but to use it you give up the accuracy afforded by a digital solution.

What is Modern UI?

We already talked a little about what Modern UI is in the introduction, where we also talked about skeumorphism and how Modern UI tries to avoid it like the plague.

So what are Microsoft’s design principles. Well, they list the following five:

► “Show pride in craftsmanship”

Effort should be put into polishing the experience for tasks that are repeatedly performed. Apps should use balance, symmetry and hierarchy such that users can expect how the app will behave. Apps should be aligned to a grid. Apps should be accessible to the widest audience even those with disabilities.

► “Be fast and fluid”

The app should be prepared for the next interaction even as the first is being performed. Interaction should be intuitive and touch friendly, with good use of motion. The UI should be immersive and compelling.

► “Be authentically digital”

The app should take advantage of the digital medium. The app is just pixels on a screen and can use colours and images in a way not possible in the real world. Apps should use meaningful motion, bold and vibrant colours and beautiful typography. Apps should connect to the cloud and be dynamic with communication.

► “Do more with less”

A design should be reduced as far as possible, so that there are minimal distractions. Only the most relevant things should be on screen. Content should be prioritised over chrome. The app should focus on being good at on thing rather than OK at many things. Move lesser used command off the chrome on to app bars, and take advantage of the charms feature.